APSI Capture — User's Manual

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What it is

APSI Capture is the photographer's Mac app from Action Plus Sports Images: it takes the frames off the camera, lets you choose, caption and correct them, and sends the finished JPEGs to the agency — one app in place of Photo Mechanic, Lightroom and an FTP client. It works on the raw files (Canon CR3 and others) and never changes them; everything you do is recorded beside each frame in a small sidecar file, and the JPEG that leaves is rendered from the raw with your crop, your corrections and the caption inside it.

Every shoot goes through the same five steps, and each has a key — the letter is the first letter of the step:

1. **Open** (`o`) — a card or a folder of frames. The app opens it as a tab; several can be open at once.
2. **Ingest** (`i`) — copy a card to the Mac, or receive frames straight from the camera over FTP or USB.
3. **Select** (`s`) — the contact sheet and the big view. Rate, colour, tag and filter until you know what you are sending.
4. **Caption** (`c`) — say what is happening in the picture. The agency's wording is built around your words.
5. **Edit** (`e`) — crop, straighten, tone and colour, on the raw.
6. **Transmit** (`t`) — send the finished frames to the destination, or save them locally.

Caption and Edit can be swapped if you prefer to correct before you write: **View ▸ Edit before Caption**. The dots that track each frame swap with them.

A frame is **ready** when it has been both captioned and edited; Transmit sends ready frames and tells you why the others are not.

Installing and updating

Install once from the DMG; after that the app updates itself.

1. Open the `APSI-Capture-….dmg` you were sent and drag **APSI Capture** into **Applications**.
2. Launch it from Applications, the Dock or Spotlight (⌘ Space, type `APSI`). It is signed and notarised by Action Plus, so macOS opens it without a warning.

3. The build you are running is in the window title (for example `0.1.211`), and in **APSI Capture ▸ About**. Quote it when you report a problem.

Updates. The app checks for a newer build every hour while it is running, and offers it with its release notes and an **Install Update** button; clicking that downloads the new build, replaces the app in Applications and relaunches it. To check at any moment: **APSI Capture ▸ Check for Updates…** (the first item in the app menu). You never need a new DMG after the first install.

Requirements. macOS 15 or later, on Apple silicon. The app receives frames from a camera over the local network, so the first time it does, macOS asks for **Local Network** permission — allow it.

Getting frames in

Frames reach the app three ways: you open a card or folder, you ingest a card onto the Mac, or the camera sends them itself.

Open a card or folder — `o`, or **File ▸ Open…**. Pick the folder that holds the frames (a card's `DCIM` folder, or any folder on the Mac). It opens as a tab named after the folder; the count in the tab fills as the frames are read, and the colours and ratings already on them appear in a second or two. Several tabs can be open at once; **File ▸ Open Recent** lists the last ones. Frames that arrive in that folder while it is open — from a card still being written, or from the camera — join the sheet by themselves.

Ingest — `i`, or **File ▸ Ingest…** (⇧⌘I). This copies a card to a folder on the Mac and opens the copy, which is what you want before the card goes back in the camera. The sheet offers:

- **Download images** — the copy itself.
- **Incremental images only** — only frames not already ingested from this card, for a card you top up during the day.
- **Locked images only** — only the frames you protected on the camera: a quick way to cull in-camera and ingest just those.
- **Apply a template to everything ingested** — the caption template (headline, event, credit, source…) goes onto every frame as it lands, so nothing sits there with only a filename.

The progress line shows `moved of total`; the tab is usable while it copies.

From the camera over FTP — for bodies that can send to an FTP server over Wi-Fi or Ethernet (Canon R1, R3, R5 and others). The app *is* the server: it listens on the local network and the frames land straight in the open tab. Set the camera's FTP destination to:

Setting	Value
Server	this Mac's address on the local network (shown in the status bar when listening)
Port	`2121`
User	`apsi`
Password	`capture`
Mode	passive

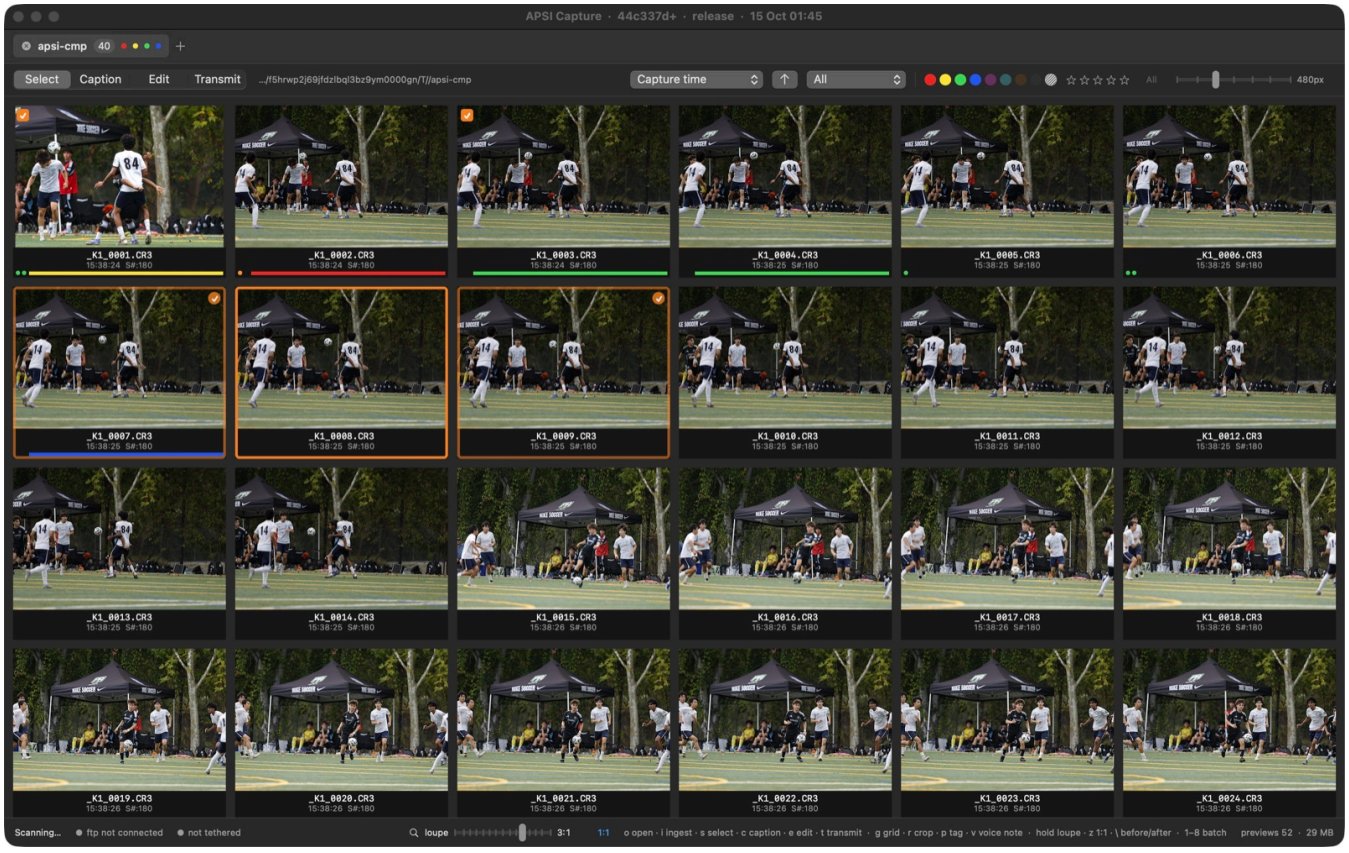
The status bar's **ftp** light turns on when the app is listening and shows each arrival. The first time, macOS asks for Local Network permission; allow it. Nothing else on the Mac is affected — the app only accepts connections, it does not open the Mac up to the internet.

Tethered over USB — plug the body in and the status bar's **tethered** light comes on; each frame transfers as it is shot. Protected-only and incremental apply here too.

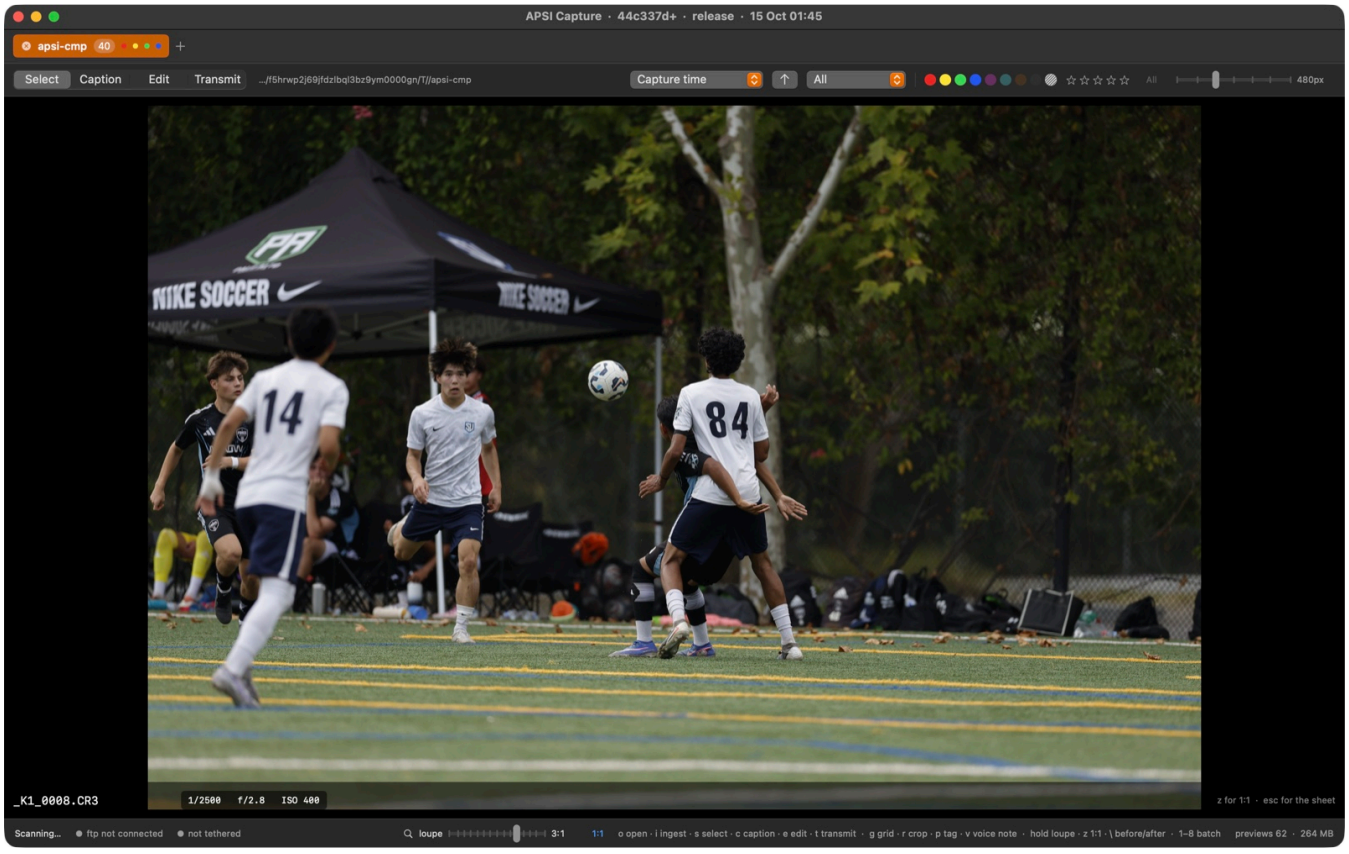
Select

Select is where you decide what you are sending. It has two views and everything is on the keyboard.

The contact sheet (`g` from anywhere) — every frame as a thumbnail with its name and time. The slider at the top right sets the thumbnail size; the sheet handles cards of ten thousand frames without slowing down, so scroll freely. Click to pick a frame; **⇧-click** picks a run, **⌘-click** adds or removes one; **⇧-arrow** grows a run from the keyboard. The frame in hand has the bright orange ring; the others picked with it are ringed in a dimmer orange with a tick — they are what a colour, a rating or a pasted setting applies to.



The big view (`s` , `space` , `return` , or double-click) — one frame filling the window, sharp enough to judge focus. Arrow keys move through the frames; the sheet position follows. `esc` or `g` goes back to the sheet.



Looking closer. Hold the mouse button down on the big view for the **loupe** — a magnified patch under the cursor, at the factor on the **loupe** slider in the status bar (⌘+ and ⌘− change it, ⌘0 is 1:1). Press `z` for **1:1**: the whole frame at one screen pixel per sensor pixel, drag to pan, `z` or `esc` to leave. Both show the sensor's own pixels with your crop and corrections applied.

Marking frames. Three kinds of mark, all in the **Metadata** menu and on the right-click menu of any thumbnail:

- **Colour class** — keys `1` to `8` (red, yellow, green, blue, magenta, cyan, brown, grey), the same eight as Photo Mechanic, shown as a bar under the thumbnail. Press the key again, or `0`, to clear. Used for batches: *these go to the wire, these to the client, these are spares.*
- **Rating** — one to five stars, from the menus.
- **Tag** — `p` toggles it; a tick appears top-left on the thumbnail. A yes/no mark for anything you like.

A mark applies to every picked frame at once, so pick a run and press the key.

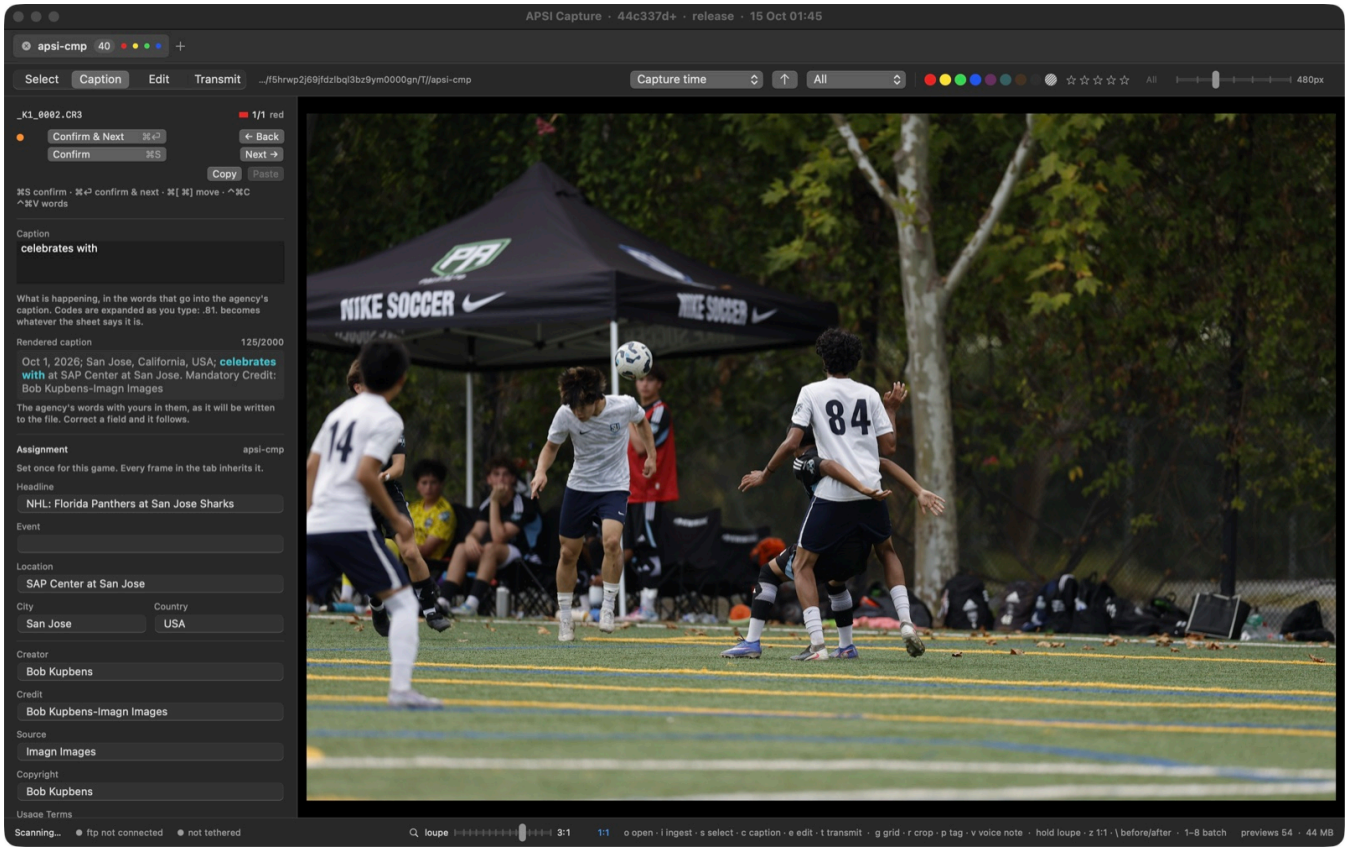
Filtering and sorting. The coloured dots in the toolbar filter to those colours (click two for both; **⌥-click** for *only this one*; click again to clear); the stars filter to that rating or better; the **All / Selected / Tagged / Untagged** control narrows further. Sort by capture time, filename, modification time, batch colour, rating, or any EXIF field under **Custom…** (aperture, shutter, ISO, lens, width, height, body, file size). The status bar counts what is shown.

Before and after — `\` shows the frame as it came off the camera, press again for your version.

Voice notes. A frame with a sound memo recorded on the camera shows a microphone badge; click it, or press `v` on the frame, to hear it. Press again to stop.

Caption

You type what is happening; the app writes the caption the agency wants around it. `c` opens the screen on the frame in hand, with the big view beside it and the filmstrip below.



The caption field is for the words that are yours: *scores the opening goal*, *celebrates with*. Everything else — the date, the place, the event, the credit — comes from the assignment and is added for you. Below the field, **Rendered caption** shows the sentence exactly as it will be written into the file, with its length (agencies cap it at 2,000 characters).

Codes. Type a number between backslashes — `\81\` — and it becomes the player: *Oscar Piastri (81) of Australia and McLaren*. The lists come from code sheets — a squad list, an entry list, one you keep yourself — loaded once under **Metadata ▸ Codes…**, where you can also see what each code means and add your own. Codes expand as you type, so the caption is a number and a verb. If two sheets disagree about a code, the app says so rather than guessing.

The assignment is set once per tab and inherited by every frame in it: headline, event, location, city and country, creator, credit, source, copyright, usage terms. It is applied at ingest if you chose a template there, and can be applied to everything later with **Metadata ▸ Apply assignment to all**. A frame that needs its own — one of a sequence going to a different agency under a different credit — can be given one, and keeps it.

Confirming. The words are saved as you type them; nothing is lost by moving on. What the app needs to know is when a caption is *finished*:

- **Confirm & Next** (⌘⏎) — marks this caption done and moves to the next frame. This is the key you press most.
- **Confirm** (⌘S) — marks it done and stays.

- ← **Back** and **Next** → (⌘[and ⌘]) — move without confirming.

The two dots beside the buttons show where the frame stands (see *The marks*). A frame with words typed but not confirmed shows orange; Transmit will tell you *caption not confirmed*.

Copy and paste (⌃⌘C, ⌃⌘V) carry the words from one frame to the next — a run from the same passage of play is the same sentence with a different number on the shirt. **Select all** in the filmstrip and **Paste** puts one caption on a whole run.

Voice notes. If the camera recorded a sound memo for the frame, the microphone button plays it (`v`), so you can caption from what you said at the time.

Edit

`e` opens the frame on the edit screen: the raw decoded on the left panel's histogram, the frame large, the filmstrip below. Every correction is a number recorded beside the frame, never a change to the raw, and the JPEG that leaves is rendered from the raw with these numbers — so what you judge here is what is delivered.



Crop and straighten — `r` , from any screen. Drag a box; the frame moves behind it and the box stays centred, as in Lightroom. Drag a corner to resize, drag inside to move, drag outside to rotate. `x` turns the crop on its side; double-click the angle to level it; `esc` puts the crop back; `return` keeps it. A crop stays in the picture's own terms, so it is identical at any size and can be re-cut later.

The sliders, in the order they are usually reached for:

Group	Controls
White balance	Temp, Tint — and **Auto** (⇧⌘U)
Tone	Exposure, Contrast, Highlights, Shadows, Whites, Blacks — and **Auto** (⌘U)
Presence	Texture, Clarity, Dehaze, Vibrance, Saturation
Sharpening	Amount; open the group for Radius, Detail, Masking
Noise reduction	Luminance, Colour; open the group for their Detail controls

Double-click a slider's name to put it back to its default. **Reset** puts the whole frame back.

Fine control (on by default) halves every slider's range — ±50, exposure ±2.5 stops, sharpening to 75 — so the same travel of the hand is a smaller change. The numbers mean the same; only the reach changes. **Auto** respects it: it will not push a slider past the end you can see.

Auto sets exposure from the lit part of the frame rather than the middle (half a sports frame is shaded crowd), brings the darkest and brightest real pixels to the ends, lifts shadows by how much of the frame is dark, and pulls highlights only for pixels that are actually clipped — a sunlit frame full of white shirts is left alone. It is a starting point, not a verdict.

Presets — the bar above the sliders saves the current sliders under a name and applies a saved one. **Before and after** — `\`.

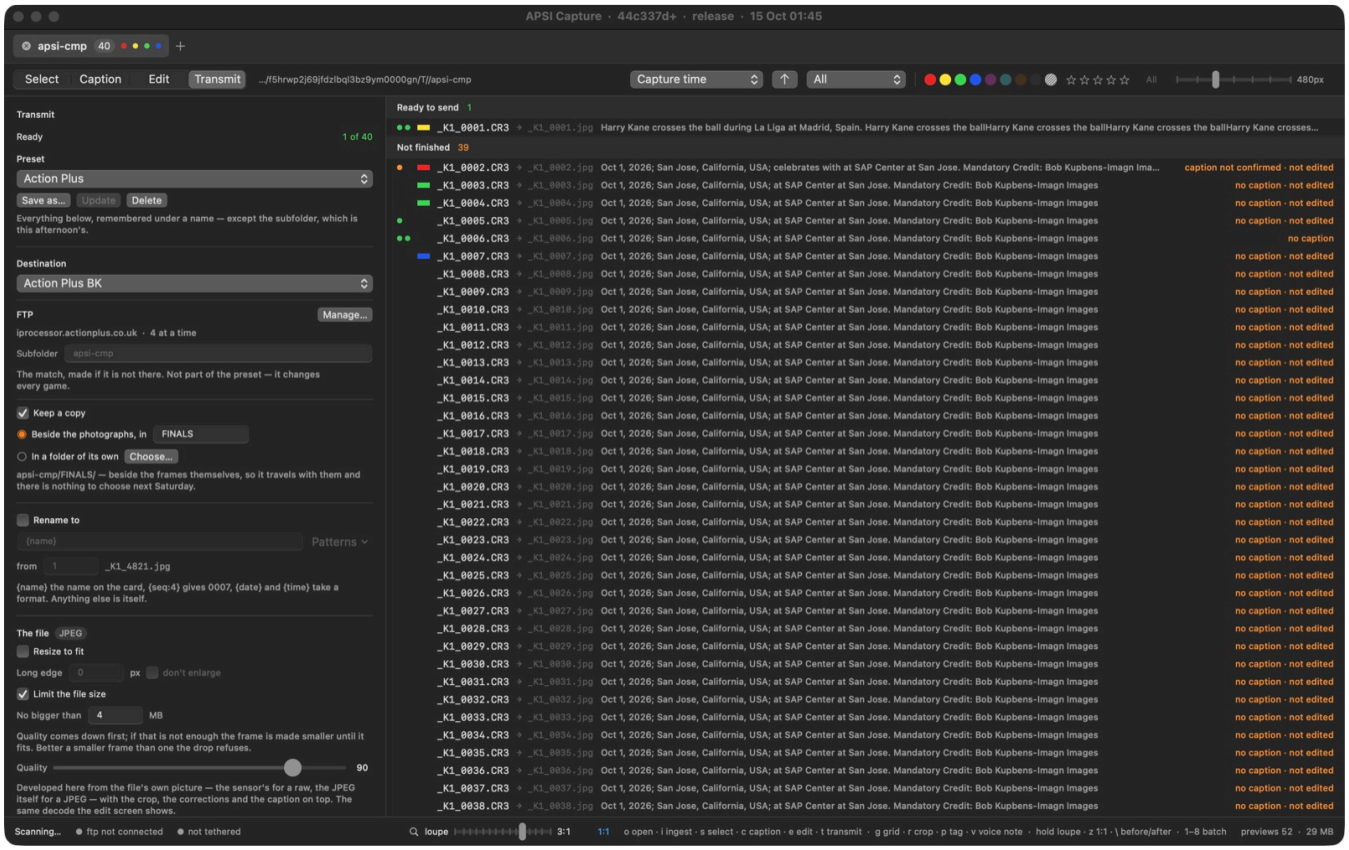
Working across a run. Correct one frame, then push the settings out:

- **Copy Settings** (⌥⌘C) and **Paste Settings** (⌥⌘V) — one frame to another.
- **Sync Settings to Selection** (⇧⌘S) — the frame in hand to every frame picked with it. Pick the run in the filmstrip (click, ⇧-click, or **All**), and the frame you corrected stays the primary; **Paste settings** in the filmstrip bar does the same.

Transmit

`t` opens the send screen. The right-hand list is every frame in the tab, split into **Ready to send** and **Not finished**, each row with its two dots, the colour bar, the outgoing filename and the rendered caption — and for an unfinished frame, why: *no caption*, *caption not*

confirmed, *not edited*. The colour and star filters from Select apply here too, so filter to the batch you mean to send.



The left-hand panel holds every decision about *how* the frames go, top to bottom, and a **preset** is simply that panel saved under a name. Renaming and resizing stay the same from game to game; the subfolder changes every game, so it is deliberately not part of the preset.

Destination — either **Save locally**, which renders the JPEGs and keeps them where you say below and sends nothing, or one of your **FTP destinations**. Destinations are set up once under **File ▸ FTP Destinations…**: host, port, user, path, passive or active, TLS, how many frames go at once, retries and timeout. The password is kept in the macOS keychain, never in a file.

Subfolder — the match: made on the server if it is not there. Type it each game.

Keep a copy — a JPEG kept on this Mac as well as sent: either **beside the photographs** in a subfolder you name (so it travels with the frames), or **in a folder of its own** that you choose.

Rename to — a pattern for the outgoing name; **Patterns** lists them. `{name}` is the name on the card, `{seq:4}` numbers from the start you set (0007), `{date}` and `{time}` take a format. Anything else is itself. The line beneath shows what the first frame will be called.

The file is always a JPEG, rendered from the raw. **Resize to fit** sets the long edge in pixels (with **don't enlarge** for frames already smaller). **Limit the file size** sets a ceiling in MB: quality comes down first, and if that is not enough the frame is made smaller until it fits — a smaller frame beats one the agency's drop refuses. **Quality** is the JPEG quality when nothing forces it lower.

Send sends the ready frames; **Include the unfinished ones** sends everything shown. Progress is per frame; a frame that fails shows the server's own words in red, and a sent frame shows a tick. Every JPEG leaves with the caption in both the IPTC and XMP blocks, the camera and lens, and the credit — but not the GPS.

The marks

Every screen shows the same marks on a frame, so a frame reads the same wherever you meet it.

Mark	Where	Meaning
Two dots — caption, then edit (they swap if Edit comes before Caption in your order)	under the thumbnail, by the name on the big view and the edit screen, by the Confirm buttons, in the Transmit list	each dot: **green** done, **orange** started, **none** untouched. Caption: orange = words typed but not confirmed, green = confirmed. Edit: green = a correction has been made. Both green = **ready**
Colour bar	along the bottom of the thumbnail; a swatch on the big view	the colour class, `1` – `8`: red, yellow, green, blue, magenta, cyan, brown, grey
Tick, top-left of the picture	thumbnail	tagged (`p`)
Orange ring	thumbnail	the frame in hand; a dimmer ring with a tick top-right = picked with it
Microphone, bottom-left of the picture	thumbnail, big view, caption screen	the camera recorded a voice note; click or `v` to play, a square while it plays
Tick in the Transmit list	Transmit	sent
Red text in the Transmit list	Transmit	the server refused it, in its own words

The status bar at the bottom shows the state of the tab: what is being read, the **ftp** and **tethered** lights, the loupe factor, and every key with what it does.

Keyboard shortcuts

Single letters work whenever a text field does not have the keyboard; click a photograph to take it back.

Key	Does	Where
`o`	Open a card or folder	anywhere
`i`	Ingest… (⇧⌘I)	anywhere
`s` `c` `e` `t`	Go to Select (big view), Caption, Edit, Transmit	anywhere
`⌘1` … `⌘4`	The four steps by number	anywhere
`g`	Back to the contact sheet	anywhere
`space` `return`	Open or close the big view	Select
double-click	Open the big view on that frame	contact sheet
`z`	1:1 on and off	big view, Edit
hold the mouse	Loupe	big view, Caption, Edit
`⌘+` `⌘−` `⌘0`	Loupe closer, wider, 1:1	anywhere
`esc`	Leave 1:1, then the big view; cancel a crop	anywhere
`←` `→` `↑` `↓`	Move through frames (rows on the sheet)	anywhere
`⇧`+arrow, `⇧`-click, `⌘`-click	Grow a run, pick a run, add one	contact sheet, filmstrip
`⇧⌘A`	Select none	anywhere
`1` … `8`, `0`	Colour class; clear	anywhere
`p`	Tag or untag	anywhere
`v`	Play the voice note	anywhere
`\`	Before / after	Select, Edit
`r`	Crop and straighten	anywhere

Key	Does	Where
`x`	Turn the crop on its side	crop
`⌘U` `⇧⌘U`	Auto tone, auto white balance	Edit
`⌥⌘C` `⌥⌘V`	Copy settings, paste settings	Edit
`⇧⌘S`	Sync settings to the selection	Edit
`⌘↩`	Confirm & Next	Caption
`⌘S`	Confirm	Caption
`⌘[` `⌘]`	Back, Next, without confirming	Caption
`^⌘C` `^⌘V`	Copy and paste the caption's words	Caption
`⌘W`	Close the tab	anywhere

When something looks wrong

Report it with the **build number** from the window title (`0.1.211` and the like) and the step you were on; most things can be reproduced from that alone.

You see	What it is	What to do
Keys beep and do nothing	A text field has the keyboard	Click a photograph; the keys come back
A frame looks flatter on Edit than on Select	Select shows the camera's own rendering; Edit shows the raw before any correction. They are different pictures by design	Nothing — what you correct is what is sent
Colours and ratings take a second to appear on a big card	The sidecars are being read, frames on screen first	Wait; they land in order
Not finished on Transmit	The frame lacks a confirmed caption, a correction, or both — the row says which	Caption and confirm, or edit; or tick **Include the unfinished ones**
macOS asks about the local network	The app is about to listen for the camera	Allow

You see	What it is	What to do
A keychain prompt the first time after an update	The app's signature changed with a new certificate	Always Allow
The camera cannot connect over FTP	Wrong server address, port, user or mode	Port `2121`, user `apsi`, password `capture`, passive; the Mac and camera on the same network
An update is offered but fails to install	The app is in a folder it cannot replace	Keep it in Applications

Known limits in this build: no sandbox yet, so it will not be on the App Store until that is done; the contact sheet keeps roughly 200 recent thumbnails sharp and re-reads the rest as you scroll back; Canon raws are the ones tested most.

View ▸ Recycling Contact Sheet should stay ticked. The unticked sheet is the old one, kept for a week as a fallback; it is unusable on large cards.